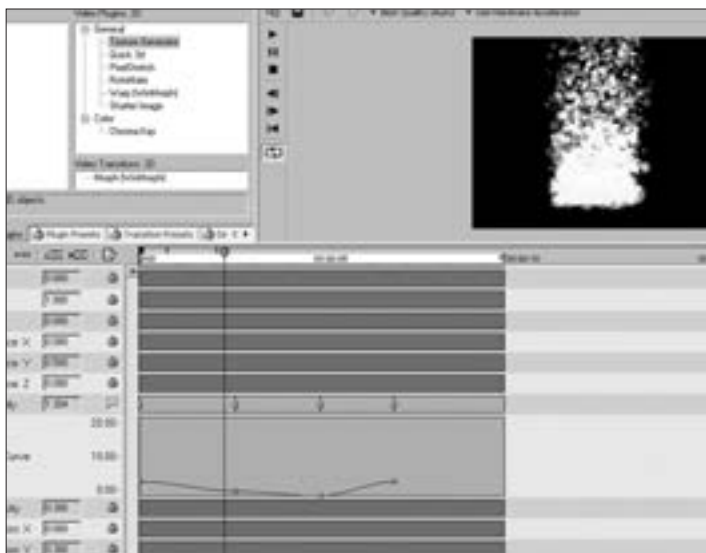




Changing the value curve for velocity makes the fire rise and fall

parameters of the particle system to create a more “alive” fire. Start with any image in the media pool—we just used `empty.png` from the Wax samples folder. The convenient thing with Wax’s particles is that they’re already set to all you need for a good fire, but not as good as one would want.

The first thing you need to do is change the particle’s Min size and Max size to a smaller value—we chose 1 and 2 respectively. Now you see the fire looking much better. Next, we change the keyframing mode for the Min Colour Alpha and Max Colour Alpha to smooth, and draw a curve like the one in the screenshot.

Next, under Emitter, change the keyframing mode for Min and Max Velocity to smooth, and draw the curves to make the particles speed up and slow down for a “raging fire” effect.

Nearly all such programs support particle systems, so no matter which one you’re using, the principles remain the same.